

San Antonio Police Department

Patrol Division — Traffic Services
315 S Santa Rosa Avenue, San Antonio, TX 78207

OFFICIAL TRAFFIC COLLISION REPORT

(210) 555-0177 | Emergency: 911

CASE NUMBER	SSPD-26-10-02-3318	WEATHER	Heavy Rain / Flash Flood Conditions (visibility 300 ft)
DATE OF INCIDENT	October 2, 2026	LIGHT CONDITIONS	Dusk / Storm-darkened
TIME OF INCIDENT	17:44 hrs	ROADWAY SURFACE	Standing Water / Flash Flood runoff
LOCATION	I-10 Eastbound, Mile Marker 571.4 (Culebra Road underpass area), San Antonio, TX 78201	TYPE OF COLLISION / VEHICLES	6-vehicle chain pileup during flash flood runoff event / 6 vehicles

SECTION 1 — RESPONDING UNITS

Responding Agency	San Antonio Police Department
Investigating Officer	Officer Marcus E. Ruiz, Badge #5519
Officer Phone	(210) 555-0177 ext. 817
EMS Agency	San Antonio Fire Dept. — Medic 3, Medic 17, Medic 22 (transported six occupants); SAFD Water Rescue on standby
Tow Companies	Alamo City Towing (V3, V4, V5, V6); owner (V1, V2)
Additional Units	Sgt. R. Garza #3341; TxDPS Trooper M. Cantu; TxDOT San Antonio District; SAFD Water Rescue Unit

SECTION 2 — VEHICLES

#	Year / Make / Model	VIN	Plate	Damage
V1	2023 Honda Pilot	5FNYP8H26PB041801	TX-APK-4418 (TX)	Rear bumper, hatch deformed — moderate; water ingress through door gaps; drivable
V2	2020 Nissan Altima	1N4BL4BV1LN341801	TX-BRX-8821 (TX)	Front and rear deformed — sandwiched; both airbags; significant water ingress; not drivable
V3	2019 Toyota Camry	4T1B11HK9KU881801	TX-CTW-3319 (TX)	Front bumper, grille, hood — severely deformed; airbag deployed; total loss likely
V4	2022 GMC Sierra	3GTU9FET9NG341801	TX-DLM-7723 (TX)	Front bumper, hood — moderate; airbag deployed; frame bend suspected
V5	2018 Ford Explorer	1FM5K8AR6JGC41801	TX-ERT-441 (TX)	Front bumper, grille — moderate to severe; airbag deployed; drivable with caution
V6	2021 Ram 1500	1C6SRFFT5MN341801	TX-FTK-224 (TX)	Front bumper — minor; airbag deployed; drivable

SECTION 3 — DRIVERS / OPERATORS

Party	Name	DOB	License	Citation
Driver V1	Elena B. Fernandez	04/17/1985	TX-F44218301	None
Driver V2	Patrick J. Murphy	09/03/1980	TX-M88234107	TX Transp. Code §545.062 — Following Too Close
Driver V3	Emeka T. Okonkwo	07/21/1992	TX-O77187213	TX Transp. Code §545.062 — Following Too Close
Driver V4	Grace Y. Lee	02/14/1989	TX-L44219801	TX Transp. Code §545.062 — Following Too Close
Driver V5	Ricardo A. Torres	11/28/1976	TX-T88219812	None
Driver V6	Francesca M. Bianchi	08/09/1999	TX-B44187320	None

SECTION 4 — PASSENGERS

Veh	Name	DOB	Injury	Transported
V2	Colleen T. Murphy	06/22/1982	Serious: head laceration, rib contusion, water ingress shock	Yes — SAFD Medic 3, to University Hospital San Antonio (serious)
V2	Brendan P. Murphy	03/09/2016	Moderate: cervical strain, wet hypothermia precautionary; child seat intact	Yes — SAFD Medic 17, to Christus Santa Rosa Childrens (stable)
V3	Ada N. Okonkwo	10/14/1995	Serious: loss of consciousness briefly, airbag burns, right arm fracture	Yes — SAFD Medic 3, to University Hospital San Antonio (serious)
V4	Thomas J. Lee	04/28/2012	Moderate: forehead laceration, airbag abrasion; booster seat intact	Yes — SAFD Medic 22, to Childrens Hospital of San Antonio (stable)
V5	Magdalena R. Torres	07/16/1978	Minor: neck stiffness — evaluated, declined transport	No
V1	Jorge L. Fernandez	11/30/2014	Minor: evaluated, no injury apparent — child safety seat intact	No — parents declined, EMS concurred

SECTION 5 — WITNESSES

#	Name	Address	Phone	Statement
W1	Howard T. Garrison	Motorist stopped on ramp before underpass flooding	(210) 555-0341	Yes — observed flash flood runoff enter roadway; saw chain reaction; written statement
W2	Lupita M. Sandoval	Culebra Rd overpass pedestrian area	(210) 555-0448	Yes — overhead view; observed standing water and vehicles stopping; video provided
W3	TxDOT Supervisor B. Rios	TxDOT San Antonio District Operations	(210) 555-0512	Yes — confirmed DMS active from 17:22 hrs; TxDOT flood sensor log provided
W4	Jerome A. Willis	Motorist in lane adjacent to V6, safely slowed	(210) 555-0617	Yes — confirmed standing water depth at approx. 6 inches before he stopped; written statement
W5	Angela T. Cruz	Owner of business at 5714 Culebra Rd — CCTV covers underpass area	(210) 555-0712	Yes — provided CCTV footage to TxDPS Trooper Cantu; footage shows water entering roadway at 17:38 hrs

SECTION 6 — PROPERTY DAMAGE (NON-VEHICLE)

I-10 EB concrete median barrier at MM 571.3 — V3 contact; one panel cracked. TxDOT notified. Roadway drainage grate (right shoulder) — partially blocked by storm debris; SAFD cleared at 18:44 hrs.

SECTION 7 — NARRATIVE

On Friday October 2, 2026 at approximately 17:44 hrs, this officer, Sgt. Garza, TxDPS Trooper Cantu, TxDOT San Antonio District, and San Antonio Fire Dept. Water Rescue Unit were dispatched to I-10 eastbound at Mile Marker 571.4 near the Culebra Road underpass in San Antonio on report of a six-vehicle chain pileup during a flash flood runoff event with multiple serious injuries. A severe thunderstorm producing flash flood conditions was in progress at the time. TxDOT flash flood sensors at the Culebra Road underpass area had detected rising water levels beginning at approximately 17:38 hrs — six minutes before the collision. The roadway surface at the underpass area had an estimated 4–6 inches of standing water, creating extreme hydroplaning risk. The incident occurred during the evening rush hour commute. V1 (2023 Honda Pilot, Fernandez) was traveling eastbound in the right lane and encountered the standing water at the underpass at an appropriate reduced speed. Fernandez recognized the flooding and activated hazard lights, decelerating to a near-stop. V2 (2020 Nissan Altima, Murphy) was following V1 and struck V1's rear at approximately 40 mph upon encountering the standing water. The impact pushed V1 forward into deeper water and V2 came to rest partially submerged in the ponding zone. V3 (2019 Toyota Camry, Okonkwo) struck V2's rear with significant force; V3's momentum on the hydroplaning surface prevented effective braking. V4 (2022 GMC Sierra, Lee) struck V3's rear at speed. V5 (2018 Ford Explorer, Torres) struck V4's rear but at a lower speed after initiating braking farther back. V6 (2021 Ram 1500, Bianchi) made contact with V5's rear at low speed, adding the sixth vehicle. TxDOT confirmed the dynamic message sign at Mile Marker 568.0 began displaying "FLOODING — ROAD MAY BE IMPASSABLE" at 17:22 hrs — 22 minutes before the collision. Witness Angela Cruz's business CCTV footage shows water entering the I-10 underpass area at 17:38 hrs and rising rapidly; this footage is in evidence under Evidence Reference EV-3318-A. Witness Howard Garrison had stopped his vehicle on the exit ramp before the underpass area upon recognizing the flooding and called 911 at 17:40 hrs, prior to the chain collision; he observed the entire sequence from his stopped position. TxDPS Trooper Cantu arrived at 17:52 hrs and confirmed the standing water in the underpass area measured approximately 5 inches depth at the deepest point (V2's position) at the time of his arrival. V2 passenger Colleen Murphy was transported with head laceration and rib contusion; EMS also noted early signs of cold water shock from the water ingress into V2's cabin. V2 passenger Brendan Murphy, age 10 (child safety seat, intact), was transported to Christus Santa Rosa Children's as a precaution, including monitoring for wet hypothermia. V3 passenger Ada Okonkwo was transported with brief loss of consciousness, arm fracture, and airbag burns. V4 passenger Thomas Lee, age 14 (booster seat intact), was transported with facial laceration to Children's Hospital. SAFD Water Rescue was on standby due to flash flood conditions; no water rescue was ultimately required. V1 passenger Jorge Fernandez, age 11 (child safety seat intact), was uninjured; parents declined transport. V5 passenger Magdalena Torres declined transport after evaluation.

SECTION 9 — SUPPLEMENTAL INVESTIGATION NOTES

SUPPLEMENTAL — FLASH FLOOD DOCUMENTATION AND TXDOT DRAINAGE INVESTIGATION: The Culebra Road underpass on I-10 EB is a documented flash flood-prone location per TxDOT San Antonio District records. TxDOT has a flood monitoring sensor system at this underpass (Sensor ID: SA-I10-571.4) which reported: 17:38 hrs — water depth 1.2 inches; 17:42 hrs — 3.8 inches; 17:46 hrs — 5.1 inches (at time of first EMS arrival). TxDOT flood sensor log and historical flood frequency data for this location have been requested (TxDOT Records Request #SA-2026-1002-441). TxDOT has confirmed that a drainage maintenance work order for Sensor SA-I10-571.4 was submitted on September 14, 2026 citing "reduced capacity" at the underpass culvert due to storm debris accumulation. This work order had not been completed at the time of the flash flood incident. SAFD Water Rescue cleared the drainage grate at 18:44 hrs; approximately 18 lbs of leaves and debris were removed. The unexecuted maintenance work order is potentially relevant to civil liability and has been documented and preserved by TxDPS Trooper Cantu. NATIONAL WEATHER SERVICE: NWS San Antonio issued a Flash Flood Warning at 17:15 hrs for Bexar County including the I-10 Culebra corridor. NWS estimated rainfall rate of 2.1 inches/hour at the time of the incident. NWS official storm report and Flash Flood Warning text requested for case file. CHILD PASSENGERS: Brendan Murphy (V2, age 10, forward-facing seat, intact) — replacement recommended per NHTSA per-crash protocol. Thomas Lee (V4, age 14, booster seat, intact) — replacement recommended. Jorge Fernandez (V1, age 11, forward-facing seat, intact) — replacement recommended. All three families received resource sheets. I-10 CLOSURE: TxDOT closed I-10 EB at Exit 569 from 17:54 to 20:22 hrs pending water recession and scene clearance. Diversion to US-90 EB. TxDOT TIM log attached as Exhibit A. CCTV footage from Angela Cruz preserved as Exhibit B.

SECTION 10 — CITATIONS / CHARGES SUMMARY

Party	Statute	Violation	Fine / Disposition
Driver V2 (Murphy)	TX TC §545.062	Following Too Close — flash flood/standing water	Civil Penalty
Driver V3 (Okonkwo)	TX TC §545.062	Following Too Close — flash flood/standing water	Civil Penalty
Driver V4 (Lee)	TX TC §545.062	Following Too Close — flash flood/standing water	Civil Penalty

SECTION 8 — OFFICER SIGN-OFF

signed

Officer Marcus E. Ruiz, Badge #5519

Investigating Officer, San Antonio Police Department Traffic Services

October 2, 2026

Date